

Gilded Nail Bar — Social Media Content Strategy

Premium Visual Content Plan — June 2026

Produced for the owner. This document outlines every piece of content needed for the first 90 days of social media marketing, with detailed creative direction for photography and videography.

01 — Content Philosophy

Every piece of content from Gilded Nail Bar should feel like a page from an editorial lookbook, not a salon's social feed. The visual language is:

Quality	Description
Warm	Golden hour tones, beige/cream dominance, bronze shadows
Textural	Every image should make you feel the material — linen, concrete, gold leaf, ceramic
Still	No frantic energy. Hands at rest. Slow movements. Quiet luxury.
Precise	Macro details, sharp focus on craft. The work speaks.
Sparse	Negative space is a feature. Let one element command the frame.

The Golden Rule

If you wouldn't frame it and hang it on a gallery wall, don't post it.

02 — Content Pillars

Four content pillars, each with a specific visual treatment:

Pillar A — The Craft (40% of content)

Close-up documentation of nail artistry. This is the portfolio.

Visual Style	Examples
Extreme macro (2:1)	Gold foil application, brush strokes, chrome powder, gel curing
Before/After	Natural hand → finished manicure in same lighting
Process detail	Cuticle work, gel building, apex formation, file work
Final reveal	Slow pan across finished nails against linen, stone, or ceramic

Camera: Macro lens (90mm–105mm), f/2.8–f/4, natural window light with white reflector **Color:** Warm shift +300K, shadows pushed to bronze, highlights to cream **Motion:** Slow-motion video at 60fps or 120fps

Pillar B — Atmosphere (25% of content)

The salon as a physical experience. Lifestyle imagery that sells the feeling.

Visual Style	Examples
Interior details	Linen curtains diffusing light, concrete texture, brass fixtures, ceramic vessels
Guest experience	Hands in soak bowl, receiving massage, selecting color from swatches
Product styling	Polish bottles arranged on marble, towels stacked on shelf, flowers in ceramic vase
Natural light studies	Sunbeam across reception desk, shadow patterns through blinds at 4PM

Camera: 35mm or 50mm prime, f/1.8–f/2.8 for environmental shots **Color:** Same warm grade, slightly desaturated, film grain added **Motion:** Static shots with gentle push-in or pull-out, 24fps

Pillar C — Education (20% of content)

Position the salon as experts. Build trust and authority.

Visual Style	Examples
Technique breakdown	"Why we use Russian dry technique" — split screen comparison
Ingredient spotlight	"French Green Clay — the mineral that draws impurities" — macro of clay
Aftercare tips	"How to make your gel manicure last 3 weeks" — text overlay on lifestyle
Myth busting	"Why you shouldn't cut your cuticles" — animated graphic

Camera: Mix of macro and talking-head style. Clean, well-lit, simple background. **Color:** Standard brand grade, text overlays in IBM Plex Mono, cream background. **Motion:** Clear, instructional. Step-by-step labeled sequences.

Pillar D — Editorial & Culture (15% of content)

Brand-building content that positions Gilded within the broader luxury/design world.

Visual Style	Examples
Typographic quotes	Brand phrases on cream background in Cormorant Garamond italic
Mood boards	Collages of textures: linen, concrete, gold, ceramic, botanical
Local culture	McKinney Ave scene, Uptown architecture, Dallas design spots
Collaborations	Behind-the-scenes with photographers, stylists, local brands

Camera: Varies. Typographic content is designed, not photographed. **Color:** Strict brand palette only. No deviation.

03 — Content Production Briefs

3.1 Photoshoot Brief — "The Hands"

Goal: Create a library of 30–50 hero images of finished nail work for the gallery and social feed.

Set Design:

- 3 surfaces: raw linen (cream), honed concrete (warm gray), matte ceramic (cream)
- 1 prop per shot max: gold leaf flake, ceramic bowl, dried botanicals, brass tool

- Natural window light only (north-facing preferred)
- White foam core reflector for fill

Shot List:

#	Description	Composition	Lens
1	Hands resting on linen, palms down, gold foil accent on ring finger	Vertical, tight crop above wrist	105mm macro
2	Hands holding ceramic bowl, water surface visible	Horizontal, waist-level	50mm
3	Single finger with gold leaf macro — extreme detail	Vertical, 2:1 macro	105mm macro
4	Both hands open, palms up, resting on concrete	Horizontal, full frame	50mm
5	Hand reaching for brass nail file on linen	Candid, motion blur on file	35mm
6	Nail art close-up — geometric line work	Vertical, diagonal composition	105mm macro
7	Hands folded, resting on knee, natural pose	Horizontal, environmental	35mm
8	Polish bottle next to finished nails, same color	Still life, top-down	50mm
9	Hand with ring, gold foil manicure, ceramic backdrop	Vertical, editorial	85mm
10	Hands interacting with raw linen fabric	Horizontal, textured	50mm

Color Grade (all images):

White Balance: +350K warmth
Shadows: Tint #584638 at 15% opacity
Highlights: Tint #f8efe1 at 10%
Contrast: +15
Clarity: -10 (soft, not sharp)
Grain: +8 (film)
Black Point: Lifted to #1a1511 (no pure black)

3.2 Photoshoot Brief — "The Space"

Goal: 15–20 interior images showing the salon environment.

Shot List:

#	Description	Time of Day
1	Reception desk from entrance	Late afternoon (golden hour)
2	Nail stations — two chairs, natural light	Mid-morning
3	Soak bar — ceramic bowls on concrete	Any
4	Product shelf — bottles arranged by color	Any

5	Linen curtain diffusing sunlight	Late afternoon
6	Waiting area — chair, magazine, ceramic	Any
7	Hallway or entrance corridor	Any
8	Treatment room detail — tools on linen	Mid-morning

3.3 Video / Reel Brief — "The Process"

Goal: 10 short-form vertical videos (15–30 seconds) for Reels and TikTok.

Equipment: Smartphone with gimbal (DJI OM6 or similar) or Sony a7S III **Format:** 9:16 vertical, 4K, 60fps (slow down to 24fps timeline for smooth motion) **Audio:** Original sound — ambient salon noise (water, ceramic clink, soft music) or recorded voiceover **Music:** Classical piano, ambient drone, or warm lo-fi — no vocals, no trendy tracks

Reel Concepts:

#	Concept	Visuals	Text Overlay
1	Gold Leaf Application — 15s	Extreme macro of tweezers placing gold leaf on gel. Slow motion.	"Hand-placed 24k gold foil. Every leaf, intentional."
2	The Soak — 15s	Hands lowering into ceramic water bowl. Ripples. Slow motion.	"The ritual begins with water. And stillness."
3	Before → After — 10s	Split screen or whip transition. Dry cuticles → finished manicure.	"Russian dry technique. No water. No shortcuts."
4	Gel-X Extension — 20s	Time-lapse of full Gel-X application in 20 seconds.	"From natural nail to structured extension. 90 minutes of craft."
5	Color Selection — 15s	Hand gliding across polish swatches. Slow, deliberate. Stops on one.	"The hardest decision you'll make today."
6	The Massage — 15s	Hand receiving warm oil massage. Slow, intimate.	"Hands that work deserve hands that rest."
7	Botanical Ingredients — 20s	Ingredients shown raw: honey drizzle, salt pour, clay scoop. Macro.	"Manuka honey. French clay. Oat milk. Not a smoothie — a manicure."
8	Studio Tour — 30s	Slow walk-through: entrance → reception → nail stations → soak bar.	"3636 McKinney Ave. Enter the cabinet."
9	Guest Arrival — 15s	Door opens, guest enters, greeted, seated. Single continuous shot.	"You're early. We're ready."
10	The Reveal — 10s	Hand moves from behind linen into light. Finished nails catch the sun.	"Done."

04 — 30-Day Content Calendar

Week 1 — Launch / Welcome

Day	Post Type	Pillar	Content	Caption Theme
Mon	Reel (15s)	A — Craft	Gold leaf application macro	Skill showcase — "Every leaf, intentional"
Tue	Static	B — Atmosphere	Salon interior — reception desk	Space introduction
Wed	Story (×3)	B — Atmosphere	Behind-the-scenes of photoshoot	BTS of content creation
Thu	Carousel (5 slides)	C — Education	"What is Russian Dry Manicure?"	Educational deep-dive
Fri	Static	A — Craft	Finished manicure on linen	Weekly inspiration
Sat	Reel (20s)	D — Editorial	Studio tour walk-through	Location showcase
Sun	Story	D — Editorial	Quote card on cream background	Reflective / ritual

Week 2 — Education & Trust

Day	Post Type	Pillar	Content	Caption Theme
Mon	Static	A — Craft	Before/After split	Transformation showcase
Tue	Reel (15s)	A — Craft	Gel-X extension time-lapse	Process appreciation
Wed	Story	C — Education	Q&A — "How long do gel manicures last?"	Guest questions
Thu	Carousel (4 slides)	C — Education	Ingredient spotlight: French Green Clay	Botanical education
Fri	Static	B — Atmosphere	Product shelf arrangement	Visual merchandising
Sat	Reel (15s)	A — Craft	Color selection slow pan	Interactive / ASMR
Sun	Story	D — Editorial	Typographic quote	Brand voice building

Week 3 — Social Proof & Community

Day	Post Type	Pillar	Content	Caption Theme
Mon	Static	A — Craft	Guest nail feature (with permission)	Client spotlight
Tue	Reel (20s)	C — Education	"Why we don't cut cuticles" myth-busting	Expert authority
Wed	Story (×2)	B — Atmosphere	Live — salon atmosphere, midday	Behind-the-scenes

Thu	Carousel (6 slides)	C — Education	Aftercare guide — "Make it last 3 weeks"	Value content
Fri	Static	D — Editorial	Mood board — linen, concrete, gold, ceramic	Brand aesthetic
Sat	Reel (15s)	A — Craft	Oil massage slow motion	Sensory / ritual
Sun	Story	B — Atmosphere	Guest thank you / shoutout	Community building

Week 4 — Conversions & Bookings

Day	Post Type	Pillar	Content	Caption Theme
Mon	Static	A — Craft	Signature Gilded Manicure hero shot	Service highlight
Tue	Reel (15s)	A — Craft	The Reveal — hand moves into golden light	Aspirational
Wed	Story (×3)	C — Education	Ingredient prep — honey, salt, oil	Process ASMR
Thu	Carousel (5 slides)	D — Editorial	"A Day at Gilded" — full guest journey	Experience storytelling
Fri	Static	B — Atmosphere	Window light on empty chair	Quiet luxury
Sat	Reel (20s)	B — Atmosphere	Guest arrival → seated → served	Hospitality focus
Sun	Story	D — Editorial	Week recap + booking link	Call to action

05 — Caption Templates

5.1 Service Showcase (Pillar A)

[Service Name] – [price]
[1-sentence sensory description of the experience]
[1-sentence technical precision detail]
Book your reservation at the link in our bio.
—
Gilded Nail Bar
3636 McKinney Ave, Uptown Dallas
Tue – Sat, 10AM – 7PM

Example — Signature Gilded Manicure:

Signature Gilded Manicure – \$120

Dry cuticle precision care, structured base alignment, and hand-placed 24k liquid gold foil leaf accents.

Each nail finished with a high-shine top coat that catches the light like still water.

Book your reservation at the link in our bio.

—

Gilded Nail Bar

3636 McKinney Ave, Uptown Dallas

Tue – Sat, 10AM – 7PM

5.2 Educational / Value (Pillar C)

[Question or provocative statement]

[2-3 sentence explanation of the technique or ingredient]

[1 sentence benefit to the guest]

Save this post for your next visit.

—

Gilded Nail Bar | 3636 McKinney Ave

Example — Russian Dry Manicure:

Why we never soak your cuticles in water.

Water causes the nail plate to expand and then contract unevenly, lifting gel and weakening the bond. Our Russian dry technique uses an e-file with diamond bits to gently remove dead cuticle – no soaking, no lifting, no shortcuts.

Your enhancement lasts 2-3 weeks longer.

Save this post for your next visit.

—

Gilded Nail Bar | 3636 McKinney Ave

5.3 Atmosphere / Lifestyle (Pillar B)

[Time of day], [light description] at Gilded.

[1 sentence – what's happening in the image]

[1 sentence – how it makes the guest feel]

—

Gilded Nail Bar
3636 McKinney Ave, Uptown Dallas

Example:

Late afternoon light through linen at Gilded.

A quiet moment before the next guest arrives. The chair is ready. The tools are set.

—

Gilded Nail Bar
3636 McKinney Ave, Uptown Dallas

5.4 Reel Captions

[Short, punchy statement – 5 words max]

[Optional: 1 clarifying sentence]

[2–3 relevant hashtags only]

Example:

Gold, placed.

Every flake, by hand.

#GildedNailBar #DallasNails

06 — Hashtag Strategy

Tier 1 — Brand (always use)

#GildedNailBar #DallasNails #UptownDallas

Tier 2 — Service / Niche (pick 2–3 per post)

#RussianManicure #GelX #GoldFoilNails #LuxuryNails #NailArtDallas
#DryManicure #OrganicNails #NailExtension #ApresGelX

Tier 3 — Lifestyle / Location (pick 1–2 per post)

#DallasSalon #LuxuryDallas #UptownDallas #McKinneyAve
#DallasBeauty #TexasNails #DallasSelfCare

Rules:

- Never more than 5 hashtags per post
- Place them at the very end of the caption, separated by a line break
- Do not use hashtags in Stories or Reels overlays
- Rotate Tier 2 and Tier 3 tags to avoid shadowbanning

07 — Content Production Checklist

Before Each Shoot

- ☐ Clean all surfaces — lint-free linen, streak-free ceramic
- ☐ Prepare 3–5 nail looks (different colors, finishes, techniques)
- ☐ Set up lighting — natural window light only, check time of day
- ☐ White reflector positioned opposite light source
- ☐ Camera battery charged, memory card formatted
- ☐ Props staged: ceramic bowl, brass file, dried lavender, gold leaf
- ☐ Shoot both horizontal (for feed) and vertical (for Reels/Stories)
- ☐ Test shot — check white balance and exposure

During Shoot

- ☐ Shoot in RAW (photos) or LOG (video) for color grading flexibility
- ☐ Capture each setup with 3 compositions: wide, medium, macro
- ☐ Nail polish colors should match the brand palette or be neutral tones
- ☐ Keep hands natural — no unnatural poses, no splayed fingers
- ☐ Shoot extra B-roll: product details, lighting, textures

After Shoot

- ☐ Color grade all images to brand spec (see 3.1)
- ☐ Export web-optimized: 1080px wide for feed, 1080×1920 for Reels
- ☐ File naming: `gilded_[content-type]_[descriptor]_[date].jpg`
- ☐ Upload to cloud backup + create social media drafts folder

08 — Recommended Gear

Photography (Entry Level — ~\$1,500)

Item	Model	Estimated Cost
Camera	Sony ZV-E10 or Fujifilm X-T30 II	\$800–\$1,000
Macro Lens	Sony 30mm f/3.5 Macro or Fuji 60mm f/2.4 Macro	\$250–\$500
Portrait Lens	35mm f/1.8 or 50mm f/1.8 (whichever system)	\$200–\$400
Reflector	5-in-1 collapsible 42" (white/silver/gold)	\$30
Tripod	Lightweight travel tripod	\$50–\$100

Photography (Professional — ~\$4,000)

Item	Model	Estimated Cost
Camera	Sony A7 IV or Fujifilm X-T5	\$2,500
Macro Lens	Sony 90mm f/2.8 G or Fuji 80mm f/2.8	\$900–\$1,200
Portrait Lens	Sony 50mm f/1.4 GM or Fuji 33mm f/1.4	\$500–\$800
Lighting	Natural light only — no strobes	\$0

Video (Smartphone Setup — ~\$300)

Item	Model	Estimated Cost
Phone	iPhone 14 Pro or newer (or any flagship)	Already owned
Gimbal	DJI OM 6	\$150
Cage + Lens Kit	Sandmarc or Moment macro + wide	\$100–\$150
Editing App	CapCut (free) or LumaFusion (\$30)	\$0–\$30

09 — Posting Schedule & Frequency

Platform	Frequency	Best Time	Format
Instagram Feed	3–4x / week	Tue–Thu 11AM, Fri 10AM	Square 1:1 or 4:5 vertical
Instagram Reels	2–3x / week	Tue, Thu, Sat 6PM	9:16 vertical, 15–30s
Instagram Stories	Daily (2–3 slides)	When content is available	9:16, photo + text overlay
Facebook Feed	Mirror Instagram (2x / week)	Wed, Fri 12PM	Same as IG feed
TikTok	2x / week	Tue, Fri 7PM	9:16, raw/native editing style

10 — Monthly Content Themes

Month	Theme	Focus	Visual Motif
July	Gold Season	Gold foil, champagne tones, summer glow	Warm gold highlights, bronzed skin, golden hour
August	The Ritual	Self-care, still moments, slow luxury	Candlelit, soft shadows, water ripples, hands at rest
September	Fall Preparation	Nail health, restoration, transition	Deep bronze, dried leaves, wool texture, darker tones

October	Texture	Material focus — concrete, linen, clay, ceramic	Extreme macro of surfaces, grit, raw materials
November	Gilded Season	Holiday gold, gift cards, party nails	Gold dominance, velvet, warm light, wrapped gifts
December	The Year in Hands	Best of 2026, client features, reflection	Montage, soft focus, gratitude

11 — Influencer / UGC Strategy

Micro-Influencer Outreach

Target accounts (Dallas-based, 5K–50K followers):

- Fashion bloggers with minimalist aesthetic
- Lifestyle accounts focused on design / wellness
- Local photographers who shoot editorial content
- Bridal-focused accounts

Proposed Collaboration:

- Offer a complimentary Signature Gilded Manicure (\$120 value)
- In exchange: 2 posts + 2 Stories over 2 weeks
- Guest owns the content — salon gets rights to repost
- Provide a styling brief so their content matches brand aesthetic

UGC (User-Generated Content) Program

- Create a branded hashtag: #MyGildedMoment
- Feature one guest post per week (with permission)
- Repost to feed and Stories
- Send a small gift (candle, polish, gift card) to featured guests

12 — Content Templates for Canva

For quick text-based content (quotes, announcements, educational cards), create Canva templates using these specs:

Element	Spec
Background	#f8efe1 (cream silk)
Heading font	Cormorant Garamond, italic, #584638
Body font	Inter, regular, #584638 or #8a7c71
Mono labels	IBM Plex Mono, uppercase, #8a7c71
Accent line	80px long, 1px high, #584638
Border	None — no stroke on cards
Spacing	Generous padding — 60px minimum on all sides

13 — Video Editing Presets

For consistent video content, apply these settings in CapCut / Premiere / LumaFusion:

Setting	Value
Color LUT	Warm cream lift, bronze shadows (see 3.1)
Grain	8% film grain overlay
Text Font	IBM Plex Mono (overlays), Cormorant Garamond (titles)
Text Color	#f8efe1 on dark backgrounds, #584638 on cream
Lower Thirds	IBM Plex Mono, 0.65rem, all-caps, letter-spacing 0.1em
Music	Classical piano, ambient drone, or warm lo-fi
Transitions	None — hard cuts only. No wipes, slides, or effects.
Speed Ramp	Slow-motion segments at 40% speed for process shots

14 — First 10 Posts to Create

Priority order — produce these before launch:

Priority	Type	Description	Why First
1	Reel	Gold leaf application macro	Most shareable, defines brand instantly
2	Static	Salon interior — reception in golden hour	Establishes location, sets atmosphere
3	Carousel	"What is Russian Dry Manicure?" — 5 slides	Educational value, builds authority
4	Reel	Before/After transformation whip transition	Proof of skill, high engagement
5	Static	Signature Gilded Manicure hero shot	Flagship service promotion
6	Reel	The Soak — hands in ceramic bowl	Sensory, calming, aesthetic anchor
7	Static	Product shelf — bottles arranged by color	Visual merchandising, design credibility
8	Reel	Studio tour — 30s walk-through	Virtual tour, invites visitation
9	Carousel	Aftercare guide — "Make it last 3 weeks"	High save rate, practical value
10	Static	Typographic quote on cream background	Brand voice, easy to produce

15 — Monthly Content Production Schedule

Week	Production Task	Output
Week 1	Full photoshoot — hands + space (see 3.1, 3.2)	40–50 photos, 5 video clips
Week 2	Edit + color grade all assets	Keep 20 best photos, 3 best clips
Week 3	Film 5 Reels from shot list (3.3)	5 finished Reels
Week 4	Schedule month's content in Meta Business Suite	12 feed posts, 8 Reels, daily Stories
Ongoing	Weekly: capture 1 new look + 1 behind-the-scenes clip	5 photos + 1 clip per week
Monthly	Review analytics, adjust content mix	Report with top 5 posts

Gilded Nail Bar — Social Media Content Plan v1.0 For inquiries: info@gildednailbar.com